

BEYOND SPACES & PLACES

The company believes that the focus should be on creating omni-connected experiences for its employees so that they can contribute regardless of where they work from

By **Smita Tripathi**

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► **AT THE AGE** of 28, Shyamala Iyer underwent nine surgeries and 13 chemotherapy cycles to fight breast cancer. She lost all her hair and was mentally distraught. After a discussion with her team leads, she joined back work at Accenture in India to take her mind off the treatment. “I was given the flexibility to work according to my pace. And when the time came, I was promoted. That made me realise that the work I do matters more than any leave of absence that I may have taken,” says Iyer who is a HR Partner Specialist, Corporate Functions at Accenture in India.

Accenture prides itself on its HR policies that focus on strengthening its culture of equality and belonging for all, the holistic well-being of its people and investing in their learning and career growth. It is because of the experience of employees like Iyer that Accenture in India is one of the top names in the BT-Taggd Best Companies to Work For in India ranking this year.

In 2017, Accenture announced it will achieve a gender-balanced workforce across the world by 2025. It is close to achieving that in India, where it employs more than 250,000 people. Over 45 per cent of Accenture’s employees in India are women and they comprise over 24 per cent of its leadership team, including Chairperson and Senior Managing Director Rekha M. Menon. Between September 1, 2020 and August 31, 2021, 49 per cent of Accenture’s all new hires in India were women. Last December, women represented 48 per cent of all promotions and 33 per cent of promotions at the MD level in India. “We sustained our focus on strengthening our culture



Key HR initiatives

- In 2017, Accenture said it will achieve a gender-balanced workforce globally by 2025. Now, over 45 per cent of its employees in India are women
- Curated unique learning and development programmes for women such as CyberHER, High-Tech Women Edge and Quantum Impact
- Life insurance nomination includes partners of people who identify as LGBT+
- People with disabilities can work from home using the right tech and tools
- Options for employees to move across teams, enabling boundary-less career opportunities

of equality through the last year by being even more intentional about how we attract, grow and develop our diverse people—women, people with disabilities and from the LGBT+ community,” says Lakshmi C., MD and Lead-Human Resources, Accenture in India. The company has curated unique learning and development programmes for women. Last year it launched CyberHER, designed to build deep technical skills amongst women employees in cybersecurity. Its High-Tech Women Edge and Quantum Impact programmes focus on fast-tracking the careers of high-performing women technologists.

Accenture also focusses on supporting people from the LGBT+ community and people with disabilities. “In early 2021 we modified our parental leave policies, such as our maternal, paternal, adoption and surrogacy leave, to focus on the importance of caregiving versus gender-